

Retention is high. Discovery is stuck.

Smart Category Explorer — an AI-driven feature to grow cross-category purchases on quick-commerce platforms like Blinkit

+20%

Category exploration

+15%

Average order value

+18%

Recommendation CTR

TARGET OUTCOME OVER TWO QUARTERS

Loyal users reorder the same basket every week

Quick-commerce apps have won the habit: users order 2–3 times a week and trust delivery speed.

That caps growth: flat basket size, low recommendation engagement and no expansion beyond core categories.

But the basket barely changes. Users buy from the same few categories and rarely try anything new.

The opportunity is not more users — it is more categories per existing user.

NORTH-STAR METRIC

Share of monthly active customers who purchase from at least one new product category each month.

Chosen because it captures both retention and basket growth: a customer who tries a new category orders more often and spends more per order.

Measured monthly, per city cohort, against a matched control group.

Evidence base: public reviews plus a primary user survey

01

Secondary research

App-store reviews, forums and market articles on quick-commerce behaviour.

02

Primary survey

Structured questionnaire with active quick-commerce shoppers.

03

AI-assisted synthesis

Theme and pain-point extraction across all responses.

04

Insight to solution

Personas, journey map, root causes, feature definition.

SUPPORTING ARTEFACTS

• OPEN ACCESS LINKS

[Survey questionnaire \(Google Form\)](#)

[Survey response summary](#)

Ordering is habitual; exploring a new category is not

25–34

Dominant age group of respondents

2–3×

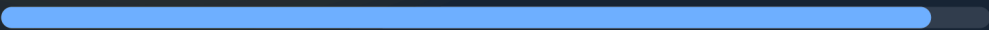
Orders placed per week

4

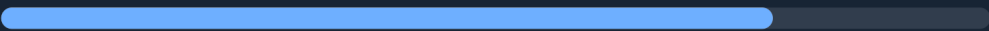
Apps kept in rotation

WHAT THEY BUY (RANKED)

Groceries & staples



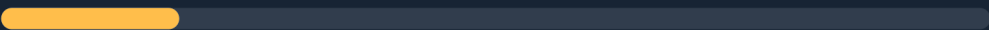
Snacks & beverages



Household care

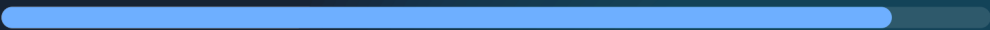


New categories

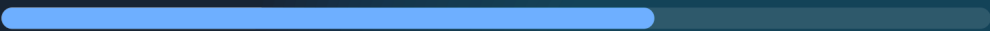


WHAT TRIGGERS A NEW CATEGORY

Discounts & offers



Urgent need



Recommendation from a friend



Curiosity while browsing



Four barriers stop users from trying a new category

01

Low awareness

New categories are never surfaced where users actually look.

02

Trust gap

Unfamiliar brands feel risky without visible social proof.

03

Choice overload

Too many options inside a two-minute shopping session.

04

Habit satisfaction

The current basket already works – why change it?

WHAT USERS NEED BEFORE BUYING SOMETHING NEW

01

Reviews & ratings

02

Price comparison

03

Clear product info

04

A personalised reason

The journey breaks at browse: no reason to explore

P1

Routine Restocker

29 · SALARIED, METRO

GOAL

Restock essentials in under two minutes.

HABIT

Orders 2–3× a week, the same short list.

FRUSTRATION

Never notices anything new.

MOTIVATOR

A relevant offer with a clear reason.

JOURNEY ·

STAGE / ACTION / PAIN POINT

Open app

Searches groceries

New categories not visible

Browse

Scans familiar items

Too many undifferentiated choices

Add to cart

Buys the usual list

No reason given to explore

Checkout

Completes purchase

Generic recommendations ignored

Root cause: recommendations earn neither trust nor relevance

SYMPTOM

Low exploration

ROOT CAUSE

Recommendations are generic and untargeted

SYMPTOM

Repeat purchases

ROOT CAUSE

Reordering is faster than discovering

SYMPTOM

Low trust

ROOT CAUSE

Reviews and ratings are not visible in-flow

SYMPTOM

Low awareness

ROOT CAUSE

New categories are never surfaced

HOW THE AI ENGINE CLOSSES THE GAP

01

Purchase history

,

02

Review & survey signals

,

03

Fit scoring

,

04

Explained recommendation

Smart Category Explorer: the right new category, with a reason

An AI-native discovery surface that learns each user's basket and recommends products from categories they have never tried — with the reason stated up front.

1 Personalised category picks

Ranks unexplored categories by fit with the user's basket.

2 Explained recommendations

“You buy coffee weekly — shoppers like you add these biscuits.”

3 AI review summaries

One short verdict instead of hundreds of reviews.

4 Smart bundles & first-try offers

Lowers the risk of the first purchase in a new category.

Ship in three phases, guarded by speed and trust metrics

PHASE 1 ·

Explained recommendations

Rules-based fit scoring on the existing home feed. A/B test on one city.

PHASE 2 ·

AI review summaries

Summarised verdicts and ratings surfaced inside the product card.

PHASE 3 ·

Bundles & first-try offers

Personalised bundles with margin-aware discounting, rolled out nationally.

GUARDRAILS · STOP SHIPPING IF THESE MOVE

- Delivery time per order stays flat
- Return rate on new categories stays within range
- Cart abandonment does not rise
- Discount cost per order stays capped

Success looks like +20% exploration and +15% AOV

+20%

Customers buying a
new category

+18%

Recommendation
click-through

+15%

Average order value

+10%

Repeat customer
retention

THE TAKEAWAY

**Personalisation turns a routine
basket into discovery — without
slowing the order down.**